

Word family: **contagious / contagiously / contagiousness / contagion / non-contagious**

Base word: contagious

Part of speech: **adjective**

Related forms:

* **contagiously** (adv.) — 有感染力地；具傳染性地

* **contagiousness** (n.) — 傳染性；感染力

* **contagion** (n.) — 傳染；感染；蔓延

* **non-contagious** (adj.) — 不具傳染性的

Useful extensions:

* **contagious disease**

* **highly contagious**

* **contagious infection**

* **contagious enthusiasm**

* **contagious laughter**

* **contagious smile**

* **contagious energy**

* **contagious mood**

Meaning in this passage

> He lights up the room without trying too hard, and his enthusiasm is genuinely **contagious**.

Here, **contagious** is being used **figuratively**.

It means:

so strong or appealing that other people quickly begin to feel the same emotion or attitude — 有感染力的；能感染他人的

Leo's enthusiasm spreads emotionally to the people around him, almost as if it were an infectious disease.

中文翻譯：

他不用刻意做甚麼，就能令整個房間的氣氛活躍起來，而且他的熱情真的**很有感染力**。

So here:

contagious enthusiasm = 能感染他人、令別人也變得興奮或投入的熱情

1. **contagious** (疾病：會傳染的) — 傳染性的

This is the core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> Chickenpox is highly **contagious**.

水痘具有高度**傳染性**。

Practice 2

> The illness is most **contagious** during the first few days.

這種疾病在最初幾天最具**傳染性**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagious = 可以由一個人傳染給另一個人的，尤其指疾病

2. **contagious disease / infection** — 傳染病；具傳染性的感染

Practice 1

> The hospital has special procedures for patients with **contagious diseases**.

醫院對患有**傳染病**的病人有特別程序。

Practice 2

> Doctors suspected that she had a **contagious infection**.

醫生懷疑她患上了**具傳染性的感染**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagious disease/infection = 能在人與人之間傳播的疾病或感染

3. **highly contagious** — 高度傳染性的

Practice 1

> The virus is **highly contagious**.

這種病毒**傳染性很高**。

Practice 2

> Because the disease is **highly contagious**, patients are advised to stay at home.

由於這種疾病**高度傳染**，病人獲建議留在家中。

MCQ-ready definition:

highly contagious = 很容易在人與人之間傳播的

4. **contagious** (情緒 / 態度：有感染力的) — 有感染力的

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> His enthusiasm is genuinely **contagious**.

他的熱情真的**很有感染力**。

Practice 2

> Her excitement was **contagious**, and soon everyone was smiling.

她的興奮情緒很**有感染力**，很快大家都笑了起來。

Practice 3

> His optimism is **contagious**.

他的樂觀態度很**能感染別人**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagious = 某種情緒、態度或反應很容易感染他人，使別人也產生相同感受

5. **contagious laughter** — 有感染力的笑聲

Practice 1

> Her **contagious laughter** made everyone else start laughing.

她那**極具感染力的笑聲**令其他人也笑了起來。

Practice 2

> The child's **contagious laughter** filled the room.

那個孩子**有感染力的笑聲**充滿了整個房間。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagious laughter = 很容易令其他人也跟着笑的笑聲

6. **contagious smile** — 有感染力的笑容

Practice 1

> He has a warm, **contagious smile**.

他有一個溫暖而**很有感染力的笑容**。

Practice 2

> Her **contagious smile** immediately lifted the mood.

她那**有感染力的笑容**立即令氣氛變得輕鬆。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagious smile = 容易令別人也感到開心、甚至跟着微笑的笑容

7. **contagious enthusiasm** — 有感染力的熱情

This is especially relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> Leo's **contagious enthusiasm** makes even ordinary activities seem exciting.

Leo **極具感染力的熱情**令普通活動都顯得有趣。

Practice 2

> Her **contagious enthusiasm** encouraged the whole team.

她**有感染力的熱情**鼓舞了整個團隊。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagious enthusiasm = 能令其他人也變得興奮、投入或有熱誠的熱情

8. **contagious energy** — 有感染力的活力

Practice 1

> The performer brought a **contagious energy** to the stage.

那位表演者把一股**很有感染力的活力**帶到舞台上。

Practice 2

> His **contagious energy** kept the group motivated.

他那**能感染他人的活力**令整個團隊一直保持動力。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagious energy = 能令周圍的人也變得更有精神、更投入的活力

9. **contagious mood / atmosphere** — 具感染力的情緒 / 氣氛

Practice 1

> The crowd's excitement created a **contagious mood**.

群眾的興奮情緒營造出一種**很有感染力的氣氛**。

Practice 2

> The celebration had a **contagious sense of joy**.

慶祝活動充滿一種**能感染人的喜悅感**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagious mood/atmosphere = 容易令在場其他人產生相同情緒的氣氛

10. **contagion** (疾病的傳播) — 傳染 ; 感染

The noun **contagion** is related but more formal.

Practice 1

> The measures were introduced to prevent **contagion**.

這些措施是為了防止**傳染 / 感染擴散**。

Practice 2

> Health officials were concerned about the risk of **contagion**.

衛生官員擔心**傳染風險**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagion = 疾病由一個人傳給另一個人的過程或現象

11. **contagion** (figurative) — 情緒、行為或影響的蔓延

This is a genuine figurative extension of the noun.

Practice 1

> Fear spread through the crowd by emotional **contagion**.

恐懼透過情緒**感染 / 蔓延**在人群中傳開。

Practice 2

> Social scientists study how behaviour spreads through **contagion**.

社會科學家研究行為如何透過**感染式蔓延**在人群中傳播。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagion = 某種情緒、行為或影響像傳染一樣在人群中蔓延

12. **contagiously** — 有感染力地

Less common than **contagious**, but valid.

Practice 1

> She laughed **contagiously**.

她笑得**很有感染力**。

Practice 2

> He spoke **contagiously** about his love of science.

他談到自己對科學的熱愛時，語氣**極具感染力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagiously = 以容易感染他人情緒或反應的方式

13. **contagiousness** — 傳染性；感染力

Practice 1

> Scientists are studying the **contagiousness** of the virus.

科學家正在研究這種病毒的**傳染性**。

Practice 2

> The **contagiousness** of her laughter made the whole group smile.

她笑聲的**感染力**令整個團體都笑了起來。

MCQ-ready definition:

contagiousness = 某種疾病容易傳播的程度；或某種情緒容易感染別人的程度

14. **non-contagious** — 不具傳染性的

Practice 1

> The condition is **non-contagious**.

這種病症**不具傳染性**。

Practice 2

> The doctor reassured us that the rash was **non-contagious**.

醫生向我們保證，這種皮疹**不會傳染**。

MCQ-ready definition:

non-contagious = 不會在人與人之間傳播的

Important distinction 1: **contagious vs infectious**

These overlap strongly, but the traditional distinction is useful.

contagious

Often emphasizes **spread from one person to another**, especially through contact or close interaction.

> a **contagious disease**

傳染病

infectious

Means caused by microorganisms and capable of infection/spread.

> an **infectious disease**

傳染性疾病 / 感染性疾病

In everyday English, the two are often used interchangeably.

But figuratively:

> **contagious enthusiasm**

is very natural.

> **infectious enthusiasm**

is also very natural.

Both mean:

****有感染力的熱情****

Important distinction 2: ****contagious vs catching****

In informal British English, ****catching**** can also mean infectious.

> Is it ****catching****?

會傳染嗎？

But ****contagious**** is more standard and widely used.

Also, figuratively:

> Her laugh is ****contagious****.

very natural.

> Her laugh is ****catching****.

possible, but less common in many contexts.

Important distinction 3: ****contagious vs communicable****

****contagious****

Ordinary language; also figurative.

****communicable****

More formal/medical and mainly literal.

> a ****communicable disease****

****傳染病 / 可傳播疾病****

You would normally not say:

>  communicable enthusiasm

But:

>  contagious enthusiasm

Important distinction 4: **contagious vs epidemic**

These are not synonyms.

contagious

describes the ability to spread between people.

epidemic

describes a disease occurring in unusually large numbers in a population or area.

So a disease may be:

* contagious but not currently epidemic

* epidemic and contagious

They describe different things.

Important distinction 5: **contagious vs contagiousness**

contagious

adjective

> a **contagious** disease

一種**具傳染性的**疾病

contagiousness

noun

> the **contagiousness** of the disease

疾病的**傳染性**

Important distinction 6: **contagious vs contagion**

contagious

describes something as able to spread.

contagion

describes the **process/phenomenon of spreading**.

> The disease is **contagious**.

這疾病有傳染性。

> Measures were taken to prevent **contagion**.

採取措施防止傳染。

Important distinction 7: literal vs figurative **contagious**

Literal

> The illness is **contagious**.

這種疾病**會傳染**。

Figurative

> Her enthusiasm is **contagious**.

她的熱情**很有感染力**。

The figurative sense is based on the metaphor:

disease spreads from person to person

→ **emotion spreads from person to person**

Important distinction 8: **contagious enthusiasm vs enthusiastic**

enthusiastic

describes the person:

> Leo is **enthusiastic**.

Leo 很有熱情。

contagious enthusiasm

adds an important extra idea:

> Leo's enthusiasm makes **other people become enthusiastic too**.

Leo 的熱情會**感染身邊的人**。

So **contagious** is not merely an intensifier meaning "very enthusiastic." It specifically implies **spread to others**.

Important distinction 9: **contagious vs inspiring**

These can overlap, but they are not identical.

contagious

Other people naturally begin to share the same emotion.

> contagious laughter

> 令人也忍不住想笑的笑聲

inspiring

Something motivates, encourages, or gives people ideas.

> an inspiring teacher

> 一位能啟發人的老師

A person's enthusiasm can be **both contagious and inspiring**, but the mechanisms differ.

Important distinction 10: **contagious vs popular**

Contagious does not simply mean popular.

> a contagious trend

would imply that the behaviour or enthusiasm **spreads from person to person**.

****Popular**** simply means many people like or support something.

Family-extension note

****Contagious**** has a very clean and useful semantic structure.

There are essentially two major modern branches:

1. ****literal medical sense****

* disease/infection can spread between people

2. ****figurative emotional/social sense****

* laughter, enthusiasm, optimism, energy, or mood spreads from person to person

This is a good case for ****conservative splitting****. We do not need separate core meanings for ****contagious laughter****, ****contagious smile****, ****contagious enthusiasm****, and ****contagious energy****. They all belong to one figurative semantic concept:

****an emotion or reaction that spreads easily to other people****

The related noun ****contagion**** likewise has both literal and figurative uses, which makes it a useful family extension.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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contagious disease	傳染性的疾病	can spread person to person	
contagious infection	具傳染性的感染	transmissible infection	
highly contagious	高度傳染性的	spreads very easily	
contagious enthusiasm	有感染力的熱情	enthusiasm spreads	
contagious laughter	有感染力的笑聲	makes others laugh	
contagious smile	有感染力的笑容	makes others smile/feel happy	
contagious energy	有感染力的活力	energizes others	
contagious mood	有感染力的情緒	emotional spread	
contagiously	有感染力地	in a spreading emotional manner	
contagiousness	傳染性；感染力	degree of spread	
contagion	傳染；感染	disease transmission	
emotional contagion	情緒感染	emotions spread socially	

| **non-contagious** | 不具傳染性的 | cannot spread person to person |

For your original sentence

> He lights up the room without trying too hard, and his enthusiasm is genuinely **contagious**.

Here:

contagious = 有感染力的；能令別人也產生相同情緒的

The image comes directly from disease transmission:

****a contagious disease spreads from person to person****

→ ****Leo's enthusiasm spreads from person to person****

So the sentence means that Leo is not merely enthusiastic himself. His enthusiasm ****affects the people around him and makes them feel excited, cheerful, or enthusiastic too****.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 他不用刻意做甚麼，就能令整個房間的氣氛活躍起來，而且他的熱情真的****很有感染力****。

For this passage, that ****figurative emotional-spread sense**** is the key one.